

SWIFT RESTORATION

Competitor Research • Central Iowa

Client: theswiftrestoration.com | **Market:** Boone, IA + 7 surrounding counties (Story, Polk, Dallas, Webster, Hamilton, Greene, Guthrie) | **Prepared:** June 2026

Status: Foundation + local competitor map + Domain Rating benchmark complete. Full traffic / keyword-gap layer pending data-tool access (see final section).

Before anything else: three corrections

1. The brief targets the wrong domain. The brief header lists **swiftrestoration.com** — that domain belongs to an **unrelated Swift Restoration in Florida / Louisiana**. The client is **theswiftrestoration.com**, confirmed by the live Google Ads and the site's own county pages. Any traffic, keyword, or backlink analysis run against swiftrestoration.com profiles the wrong company.

2. Possible duplicate property. **swiftrestoration-us.com** lists the same Boone street address (2128 Mamie Eisenhower Ave) but a different phone. Either a second site the client owns — splitting their own rankings and citations — or an impersonation / lead-aggregator. Domain Rating 0.0, so it is a duplicate-content and NAP-consistency risk, not an authority one. Confirm ownership before any link or citation work.

3. Service area, from their own site. Boone, Story, Polk, Dallas, Webster, Hamilton, Greene and Guthrie counties — a rural home base (Boone) bleeding into the Des Moines metro. Two very different competitive environments that should be attacked differently.

Market structure & strategic reframe

Home turf — Boone / Story / Greene / Guthrie / Hamilton. Rural, thinner competition, lower volume, **winnable**. Realistic local-pack and location-page wins in 30–90 days.

Des Moines metro — Polk / Dallas. High volume, saturated, dominated by decades-old independents and multiple franchise units. A long-term play, not a quick win.

The reframe: for a low-authority local operator, the war is the Google Map Pack and Local Services Ads — not organic backlink parity with national franchise *corporate* domains. The numbers below make this concrete.

Authority benchmark — Domain Rating

Source: Ahrefs free Domain Rating endpoint, June 2026. Higher = stronger backlink authority (0–100 scale).

Competitor	DR	Domain measured	Property	Read
Swift Restoration (client)	3.2	theswiftrestoration.com	Own domain	Baseline. Mid-pack among the true independents.
Dream Steam	15.0	dreamsteaminc.com	Own domain	Strongest independent. A real but closeable gap.
515 Restoration	0.0	515restoration.com	Own domain	Authority near zero. Beatable on fundamentals.
SERVPRO of Ames (microsite)	0.8	servproames.com	Microsite	If it ranks via this, Swift already leads on authority.

Competitor	DR	Domain measured	Property	Read
SERVPRO (corporate)	76.0	servpro.com	Corporate	Ames unit's /locations/ pages inherit this. Can't out-link.
ServiceMaster by Rice	72.0	servicemasterrestore.com	Corporate	Borrowed corporate authority.
Restoration 1 of Des Moines	63.0	restoration1.com	Corporate	Borrowed corporate authority.
swiftrestoration-us.com	0.0	swiftrestoration-us.com	Unknown	No authority. Confirm ownership (duplicate-content risk).

What the numbers say. Authority is bimodal. Among the businesses Swift actually fights on home turf — the independents — Swift (3.2) already sits **above** 515 Restoration (0) and the SERVPRO-of-Ames microsite (0.8), and below only Dream Steam (15). The franchise 'strength' is borrowed from corporate domains (76 / 72 / 63); you cannot out-link those and shouldn't try. On those competitors the entire winnable battle is GBP, review velocity, and genuinely town-specific content.

One SERP check worth doing: is SERVPRO of Ames ranking locally via the DR-76 corporate subfolder or the DR-0.8 microsite? If the microsite, Swift is already ahead on authority and the page-quality + GBP fight is very winnable.

Strength / Weakness / Opportunity — with authority folded in

Competitor	DR	Strength	Weakness	Opportunity for Swift
SERVPRO of Ames	76 corp 0.8 site	Strong GBP, town location pages, reviews	Franchise messaging feels generic; authority is borrowed, not local	More localized pages + highlight faster local response; win GBP velocity
Dream Steam	15	Long-established local brand	Limited content depth	Build stronger educational + insurance-claim content
515 Restoration	0	Good local / exurb targeting	Authority near zero	Outperform on technical SEO, reviews, and structured town content
ServiceMaster by Rice	72 corp	High (corporate) authority	Focused on Des Moines metro	Own Boone + rural markets before they expand outward
Restoration 1	63 corp	National franchise backing	Generic, templated location pages	Publish unique town pages with local case studies + photos

Baseline: Swift Restoration DR 3.2.

SEO / Organic & Local track

Service-page & location-page strategy

SERVPRO of Ames runs individual town pages (Boone, Ogden, Madrid, Story City, Nevada, Huxley...) — the single biggest organic advantage on Swift's home turf. The location-page expansion already in the SEO plan is the correct counter, but it is **blocked until the duplicate-title / duplicate-H1 plugin conflict is fixed** (Screaming Frog: Page Titles Multiple = 51 URLs, H1 Multiple = 47, both flagged as plugin/module conflicts). Sequence: fix plugin → confirm unique titles/H1s → build Boone / Ames / Ogden / Madrid / Story City / Nevada pages with unique local content.

Keyword rankings & gaps — pending data tool

Pulls to run vs. SERVPRO of Ames, Dream Steam, ServiceMaster by Rice: baseline organic keywords for Swift; competitor keyword sets; content gap filtered to local intent ('water damage restoration [town]', 'flooded basement

[town]', 'mold removal [town]', emergency / 24-7 modifiers); volume sizing for priority towns (Ames and Des Moines carry the volume; Boone/rural is low-volume, low-competition).

Backlinks & local citations — pending data tool + manual

Referring-domain gap vs. Tier A/B (goal is local *relevance*, not raw volume). Citation targets to verify NAP on: Google Business Profile, Bing Places, Apple Business Connect, Yelp, BBB, Angi, Nextdoor, Boone/Ames chambers, IICRC locator, insurance preferred-vendor lists. Resolve the swiftrestoration-us.com address question first — duplicate NAP across two domains poisons citation consistency.

Google Business Profile audit — manual, highest leverage

Capture for Swift and each Tier-A/B competitor: review count, average rating, review velocity (last 90 days), primary + secondary categories, photo count, post activity, Q&A, and Verified / Google Guaranteed status. SERVPRO of Ames is the GBP benchmark to beat in Boone/Story. For a local emergency business, GBP review volume + velocity is usually the highest-leverage lever in the whole plan — prioritize it.

Content / FAQ / internal linking — benchmark national franchises

Use national franchise sites as the model for FAQ depth, seasonal content (frozen-pipe/winter, storm/derecho — both genuine Iowa drivers) and category→town internal linking. Mine the structure; localize the substance.

Paid / Google Ads track

Swift's current paid posture (Ads Transparency Center)

- Two standard Search ads, both generic ('Call Now For Water Help') — no town, no brand, no differentiator.
- **Live defect:** ad #1's description shows a double-encoded ampersand — 'extraction & drying' rendering literally to searchers. Fix immediately.
- Advertiser shown as 'Austin Moorman' (a personal name), 'Verified'. Confirm who controls the account. Note: this is Google *advertiser identity* verification — not the LSA Google Guaranteed badge. No evidence of LSA.

Competitor ad & landing-page research — method

For each Tier-A/B competitor: (1) check their Ads Transparency Center entry for active creative + messaging angles; (2) check whether they appear in the LSA pack for 'water damage restoration [town]'; (3) score landing-page experience (click-to-call above fold, town in H1, trust signals, form length, mobile speed). The franchises are the likeliest sophisticated paid competitors.

Local Services Ads — the real paid opportunity

Water-damage restoration is LSA-eligible and typically the highest-ROI emergency channel. Any town where Tier-A/B competitors are absent from the LSA pack is open ground. Tie to onboarding: GBP verification is now mandatory for LSA accounts (Oct 2025), so the GBP work above is a prerequisite.

Status — done vs. pending

Done (public data + audit + Ahrefs free DR): domain correction, duplicate-domain flag, service-area definition, market segmentation, tiered local competitor set, Domain Rating benchmark, leader's location-page strategy, Swift's current ad posture + live bug.

Pending — needs a paid data tool. Organic traffic estimates, ranking-keyword counts, referring-domain detail, and the head-to-head keyword gap require either **Semrush connected** (not currently available in this workspace) or **Ahrefs Site Explorer access restored** (the connected account returned 'Insufficient plan' on those endpoints; only the free DR metric is accessible).

Pending — manual SERP/GBP work: per-competitor GBP audit, landing-page scoring + LSA-pack mapping, citation-gap verification.